

iPhone 17e

Apple's case for the faithful

The iPhone 17e at Rs 64,900 is Apple's most accessible iPhone, the point at which someone weighing Android against iOS makes their choice, or someone already inside the Apple ecosystem finds their way back in.

BUILD AND DESIGN

The iPhone 17e is, in most respects, the iPhone 16e with a chip upgrade and a toughened front panel. The flat aluminium edges, the Face ID notch, the overall proportions, none of these has changed. If you found the 16e's design clean and composed, the 17e continues that with no concessions. If you found it dated, 2026 has brought no update to prompt a reassessment.

At 169 g and 7.8 mm, it is one of the lighter and slimmer phones in its segment. The build is tight and confident, with no ambiguity in the material quality of the frame and the glass front. The upgrade from Ceramic Shield to Ceramic Shield 2 is the single meaningful hardware change on the outside, offering improved drop resistance that Apple claims is meaningfully better than its predecessor.

Colour options are conservative: Black, White and Soft Pink. There is nothing wrong with these choices; each is executed well and the Soft Pink is warmer and more characterful than the name implies.

The Face ID notch occupies meaningful real estate at the top of the display. In 2026, when most phones at or below this price have moved to a punch-hole cutout, the notch reads as a carry-over compromise rather than a deliberate design decision. It is not

₹64,900



their lineups. Users arriving from any modern Android flagship or even last year's mid-range Android phones will notice the difference immediately. It does not make the phone unusable and Apple's software is tuned to present the experience as fluidly as possible within the constraint, but the limitation is real and persistent.

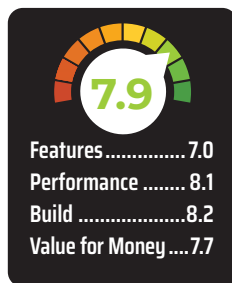
At 2,300 nits peak, brightness is competitive but trails the leaders in its class. Colour accuracy is a genuine strength. Apple's display tuning in the Natural mode is well-calibrated, with consistent white balance and accurate colour rendering that serve photo review and content consumption well.

SOFTWARE

The iPhone 17e runs iOS 26 and the software experience remains one of Apple's most consistent competitive advantages. iOS is polished, consistent and designed with a coherence that extends across every element of the interface. There is no bloatware. The system-level animations and transitions are calibrated to feel deliberate rather than decorative. For users who want a phone that stays out of their way and works predictably, iOS continues to set the standard.

The ecosystem integration is the layer beneath the operating system that truly differentiates the iPhone for buyers already invested in Apple's hardware. AirPods connect instantly and hand off between devices without friction. Continuity features between iPhone and Mac such as Handoff, Universal Clipboard and iPhone Mirroring, work reliably. iMessage on iPhone remains meaningfully different from the cross-platform equivalent. For users with multiple Apple devices, the iPhone 17e is not just a phone; it is the mobile anchor of a coordinated system and no Android alternative fully replicates that.

Apple supports its devices with iOS updates for multiple years and the iPhone 17e can be expected to receive



unusable; Face ID itself remains a reliable and fast biometric unlock, but the estate it consumes at the top of a 6.1-inch panel is noticeable.

DISPLAY

The iPhone 17e carries a 6.1-inch Super Retina XDR OLED display with a peak brightness of 2,300 nits. The OLED technology delivers the expected strengths: deep blacks, strong contrast and accurate colour reproduction. HDR content in supported streaming titles renders well and outdoor visibility, while not at the top of its segment, is sufficient for most daylight conditions.

The constraint that defines this display is the 60 Hz refresh rate. In 2026, at Rs 64,900, this is the iPhone 17e's most difficult specification to defend. Competitors at Rs 40,000 and below have standardised 120 Hz across